

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 5
 ♥ 7 3
 ♦ 6 5 4 2
 ♣ K Q 10 8 7 5

♠ A K 9 6 4

♥ K Q 5

♦ K Q J 7

♣ 3



♠ 7 2
 ♥ 10 9 8 6 2
 ♦ 9 8 3
 ♣ A J 4

♠ Q J 10 8 3

♥ A J 4

♦ A 10

♣ 9 6 2

SOUTH has a minimum 1 ♠ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps. She doesn't even suspect what's about to befall!

NORTH hears the 1 ♠ bid and all he wants to know is whether SOUTH has one, two or three Aces. So he uses the Blackwood convention, 4NT.

SOUTH has two Aces so she bids 5 ♥ (5 ♣ would show zero Aces, 5 ♦ would show one Ace, etc).

NORTH has heard enough and bids 6 ♠.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♥
Pass	6 ♠		
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♣K			

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 8 3

♥ J 9 4

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 10 4 2

♠ A 7 4

♥ Q 5

♦ K 7 6 4

♣ 7 6 5 3



♠ Q 10 9 5

♥ 10 3

♦ Q J 9

♣ K Q J 8

♠ 6 2

♥ A K 8 7 6 2

♦ A 10 3

♣ A 9

SOUTH has an above-minimum strength hand with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1♥.

NORTH, with 9 points, is a little too weak to bid at the 2-level so she bids a catchall 1NT.

SOUTH shows his 6-card suit and extra strength by jumping to 3♥, which NORTH raises to 4♥ since two trumps is now adequate support.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♦ 2			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 2
♥ K 10 2
♦ A 10 9
♣ J 9 8 5 4

♠ J 10 8 3
♥ A Q 7 4
♦ J 5 3
♣ 7 6



♠ A 6 5
♥ J 9 6 5
♦ K Q 8 4
♣ 10 3

♠ K Q 7 4
♥ 8 3
♦ 7 6 2
♣ A K Q 2

SOUTH has 14 points and opens her 4-card ♣ suit.

NORTH must respond, and with two 4-card Majors bids them "up-the-line", saying 1 ♥.

SOUTH now shows his 4-card ♠ suit, and NORTH again must bid. Since NORTH is pretty weak he just raises to 2 ♠, which SOUTH happily passes.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠		
All Pass			
2 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♠ 9			

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 10 4
♦ Q J 9 5 2
♣ A 5 4

♠ A 9 4

♥ A 7

♦ K 8 3

♣ K J 9 6 2



♠ J 10 8 2

♥ 9 8 6 5 2

♦ 7 4

♣ 7 3

♠ K Q 7

♥ K Q J 3

♦ A 10 6

♣ Q 10 8

SOUTH has a maximum 17 point 1NT bid.

NORTH, with 16 points, can't tell if there are enough points for slam. If SOUTH has 17 points then a slam should be makeable, but if SOUTH has only 15 points then he should settle for game.

The 4NT raise solves the problem. It tells SOUTH to bid 6NT with 17 points, pass with 15 points, and use best judgment with 16. Here SOUTH bids the slam.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1NT
Pass	4NT	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			
Lead: ♦ Q			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 5
♥ A K 10 9
♦ J 8 3 2
♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ K 9 7 3

♥ 8 4 2

♦ A K 5

♣ J 7 6



♠ J 10 4

♥ Q 7 6

♦ Q 10 9 6

♣ A 8 5

♠ A Q 8 6 2

♥ J 5 3

♦ 7 4

♣ K Q 2

NORTH has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding. But when SOUTH opens 1♠ NORTH should show her "almost opening strength" by jumping to 3♠.

SOUTH has just 13 points, and knowing NORTH has less than 13 he passes.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

Pass

1♠

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by South

Lead: ♥K

Board 6

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 4
 ♥ 10
 ♦ J 10 7 4 3
 ♣ 10 8 4

♠ 7 3

♥ Q 8 6 4 2

♦ A 8 6

♣ K 9 5



♠ A 9 6 5

♥ J 9

♦ 9 2

♣ A J 7 3 2

♠ 10 8 2

♥ A K 7 5 3

♦ K Q 5

♣ Q 6

After SOUTH opens with 1♥, NORTH has a small "dilemma". With 11 points she really is only strong enough to make a jump raise to 3♥. But, with five trumps the hand deserves more. So she just bids 4♥ instead.

Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your partner opens with you should just jump right to game.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♠K